

BUSINESS RESPONSIBILITY REPORT

SECTION A: GENERAL INFORMATION ABOUT THE COMPANY

1.	Corporate Identity Number (CIN) of the Company:	L19201WB1931PLC007261	
2.	Name of the Company:	Bata India Limited	
3.	Registered address:	27B, Camac Street, 1 st Floor, Kolkata - 700016, West Bengal	
4.	Website:	www.bata.in	
5.	E-mail id:	share.dept@bata.com	
6.	Financial Year reported:	April 1, 2021 - March 31, 2022	
7.	Sector(s) that the Company is engaged in (industrial activity code-wise):	NIC Code	Description
		47713	Retail sale of footwear
		47714	Retail sale of leather goods and travel accessories of leather and leather substitutes
		46413	Wholesale of footwear
		46499	Wholesale of leather goods & travel accessories
8.	List three key products / services that the Company manufactures / provides (as in balance sheet):	Footwear for Children, Men and Women, Accessories	
9.	Total number of locations where business activity is undertaken by the Company:	None	
a.	Number of International Locations:		
b.	Number of National Locations:		
10.	Markets served by the Company:	The Company has 4 operational manufacturing units located at (i) Batanagar, Kolkata, West Bengal, (ii) Bataganj, Patna, Bihar, (iii) Peenya Industrial Area, Bengaluru, Karnataka, (iv) Batashatak, Hosur, Tamil Nadu. It retails in more than 1500 Bata own and franchisee stores, on bata.in and in thousands of multi-brand footwear dealer stores pan-India.	
		The Company has its retail presence mainly in the Metro cities, A-1 cities, Tier I, Tier II and Tier III cities across India. For non-urban areas, the Company sells its footwear through its network of more than 500 distributors.	

SECTION B: FINANCIAL DETAILS OF THE COMPANY

1.	Paid-up Capital:	Rs. 642.64 Million
2.	Total Turnover:	Rs. 23,877.19 Million
3.	Total profit after taxes:	Rs. 1008.87 Million
4.	Total Spending on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) as percentage of profit after tax (%):	Rs. 58.73 Million, i.e., 2.06% of profit after tax
5.	List of activities in which CSR expenditures have been incurred:	The details of CSR activities undertaken by the Company and CSR expenditures incurred thereon during the financial year 2021-22 by the Company have been provided in the Board's Report and also in the 'Annual Report on CSR Activities', annexed to the Board's Report marked as Annexure - IV .

SECTION C: OTHER DETAILS

1.	Does the Company have any Subsidiary Company / Companies?	Yes. The Company has two Wholly Owned Subsidiaries (WOSs) as on March 31, 2022, viz., (i) Bata Properties Limited; and (ii) Way Finders Brands Limited.
2.	Do the Subsidiary Company / Companies participate in the BR Initiatives of the parent Company?	The operations of these WOSs being insignificant, presently there is no direct participation by these WOSs in the BR initiatives of the parent Company.
3.	Do any other entity / entities (suppliers, distributors etc.) that the Company does business with, participate in the BR initiatives of the Company? If yes, then indicate the percentage of such entity / entities? [Less than 30%, 30- 60%, More than 60%]	Yes. The Company actively supports and encourages its suppliers and other stakeholders to participate in the BR initiatives of the Company. The Company ensures prohibition of child labour and forced labour in its workplaces and refrain itself from engaging with such vendors, suppliers and distributors who engage child labour or forced labour in their business operations. At present, the Company does not have any established mechanism to ascertain the level of participation of the vendors, suppliers, distributors, etc. in various BR initiatives of the Company. Hence, it is difficult to quantify the percentage of such entities for disclosure purposes.

SECTION D: BR INFORMATION

1.	Details of Director responsible for BR:	
(a)	Details of the Director responsible for implementation of the BR policies:	
	1. DIN:	08525366
	2. Name:	Mr. Gunjan Shah
	3. Designation:	Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer
(b)	Details of the BR Head:	
Sl. No.	Particulars	Details
1.	DIN:	08525366
2.	Name:	Mr. Gunjan Shah
3.	Designation:	Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer
4.	Telephone Number:	(0124) 3990100
5.	E-mail id:	head.brinitiatives@bata.com

2. Principle-wise (as per NVGs) BR policies**(a) Details of compliance (Reply in Y / N)**

Sl. No.	Questions	Business Ethics	Product Responsibility	Wellbeing of Employees	Stake-holder's Engagement & CSR	Human Rights	Environment	Public Policy	CSR	Customer Relation
		P	P	P	P	P	P	P	P	P
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1.	Do you have policy/policies for?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
2.	Has the policy being formulated in consultation with the relevant stakeholders?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
3.	Does the policy conform to any national / international standards? If yes, specify? (50 words)	The policies of the Company generally conform to the principles of the National Voluntary Guidelines (NVGs) on Social, Environmental and Economic Responsibilities of Business, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), Government of India.								
4.	Has the policy being approved by the Board? If yes, has it been signed by MD / owner / CEO / appropriate Board Director?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
5.	Does the Company have a specified committee of the Board / Director / Official to oversee the implementation of the policy?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
6.	Indicate the link for the policy to be viewed online?	The policies which are mandatorily required to be uploaded on the website of the Company have been uploaded on www.bata.in under the tab "Investor Relations > Company Policies" at https://www.bata.in/investor-relations.html and is available at the link https://www.bata.in/company-policies.html								
7.	Has the policy been formally communicated to all relevant internal and external stakeholders?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
8.	Does the Company have in-house structure to implement the policy/policies?*	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
9.	Does the Company have a grievance redressal mechanism related to the policy / policies to address stakeholders' grievances related to the policy / policies?	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
10.	Has the Company carried out independent audit / evaluation of the working of this policy by an internal or external agency?**	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

*The Company also takes inputs / support from outside agencies, whenever considered necessary, in preparation and implementation of respective Policies in order to adopt the best industry practices.

**Audit / evaluation of the working of these Policies had been conducted by the Internal Audit Team of the Company.

(b) If answer to the question at serial number 1 against any principle, is 'No', please explain why: Not Applicable.

3. Governance related to BR

a.	Indicate the frequency with which the Board of Directors, Committee of the Board or CEO to assess the BR performance of the Company. Within 3 months, 3-6 months, Annually, More than 1 year.	The Board assesses the BR performance annually.
b.	Does the Company publish a BR or a Sustainability Report? What is the hyperlink for viewing this report? How frequently is it published?	This is the sixth BR Report of the Company for publication. The BR Reports may be viewed on the website of the Company www.bata.in and the same is available at the link https://www.bata.in/annual-reports.html . The Company is publishing the BR Report annually.

SECTION E: PRINCIPLE-WISE PERFORMANCE

PRINCIPLE 1: BUSINESS SHOULD CONDUCT AND GOVERN THEMSELVES WITH ETHICS, TRANSPARENCY AND ACCOUNTABILITY

1. Does the policy relating to ethics, bribery and corruption cover only the Company? Yes / No. Does it extend to the Group / Joint Ventures / Suppliers / Contractors / NGOs / Others?

The Company considers Corporate Governance as an integral part which leads to increase in operational efficiencies and sustained long term value creation for all the stakeholders. The Board of Directors of the Company has adopted a Code of Conduct and Business Ethics (along with Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption Directives). The Company has introduced a vigil mechanism system across all its functions and establishments through a Whistle Blower Policy as approved by the Board of Directors of the Company and has uploaded the Whistle Blower Policy on the website of the Company i.e., www.bata.in. The Code of Conduct is applicable to the Board of Directors and all employees of the Company and its subsidiaries. An annual affirmation on compliance and adherence to the Code of Conduct and Business Ethics is obtained from the Directors and Senior Managerial Personnel including Functional Heads. The Anti-Bribery and Corruption Directives and the Ethical View Reporting Policy also extends to the Company's business partners, e.g., suppliers, vendors, distributors, contractors, etc.

2. How many stakeholder complaints have been received in the past financial year and what percentage was satisfactorily resolved by the management? If so, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so.

In addition to the introduction of Vigil Mechanism/Whistle Blower Mechanism to enable all stakeholders to freely communicate their grievances, the Company has also implemented its Policy under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 and uploaded the same on the website of the Company, www.bata.in. Further, number of complaints received under the said Policy, during the financial year under review, has been given in the Corporate Governance Report, which forms part of this Annual Report. During the financial year under review, 84% of the complaints received were disposed of (including withdrawn).

The Company has also created an exclusive e-mail id: share.dept@bata.com to enable the Members / Investors of the Company to communicate their grievances directly.

The details of investors' complaints received and resolved during the year under review have been provided in the Corporate Governance Report, which forms part of this Annual Report.

PRINCIPLE 2: BUSINESS SHOULD PROVIDE GOODS AND SERVICES THAT ARE SAFE AND CONTRIBUTE TO SUSTAINABILITY THROUGHOUT THEIR LIFECYCLE

1. List up to 3 of your products or services whose design has incorporated social or environmental concerns, risks and / or opportunities.

- i. The Company is driving various 3R & Waste Management initiatives:
 - Replaced plastic/jute bags by reusable HDPE bags
 - Replaced solvent-based adhesive by environment friendly water-based adhesive
 - 100% recycling of the following
 - EVA Hawaii waste
 - Rubber Hawaii waste
 - PVC waste
 - Laminated Textile waste

- Tyre Upcycling for sole making
 - Packing Re-Design: Eliminating carry bags by innovative shoe box handles
 - ii. The Company has also replaced Natural Rubber with EVA & Leather in Sole making with PU & PVC to conserve natural resources.
 - iii. The Company has also replaced Fossil Fuel based boilers with eco-friendly Bio-Mass waste-based briquettes.
- 2. For each such product, provide the following details in respect of resource use (energy, water, raw material etc.) per unit of product (optional):**

(a) Reduction during sourcing / production / distribution achieved since the previous year throughout the value chain?

Consumption per unit of Production	Current Financial Year 2021-22	Previous Financial Year 2020-21
Electrical Energy (Kwh per pair of Shoes)	0.51	0.63
Thermal Energy (Equivalent kwh per pair of shoes)	0.48	0.55
CO ₂ Emission (Kg CO ₂ per pair of Shoes) [consider: 0.537 kg CO ₂ /1 kwh Grid electricity & 0.268 kg CO ₂ / kwh fuel oil]	0.40	0.49

(b) Reduction during usage by consumers (energy, water) has been achieved since the previous year?

Compared to last year, the Company has shown remarkable improvement in reducing consumption per pair of Electrical Energy @ 19%, Thermal Energy @ 13% & CO₂ Emission @ 18%. Company continuously takes appropriate measures to reduce the consumption of thermal energy, electrical energy and water.

The Company has installed modern and efficient machineries across its manufacturing plants and has been able to save energy and water.

Environmental KPIs are observed regularly on monthly basis and necessary steps/initiatives are decided basis that. Installation of LED lights, motion sensors, turbo ventilators, energy efficient air compressor and conditioners, integrated APFC electrical panel, VFD/Servo motors etc. have significantly contributed in reducing electricity consumption.

Water conservation initiatives at the manufacturing facilities are driven through Zero Liquid Discharge (ZLD) facilities, Sewage Treatment Plants (STP), Rainwater Harvesting tanks for water treatment/reuse – thereby reducing water consumption and wastage. The Company also continuously encourages its employees to save the natural resources wherever possible through campaigning & VMs.

3. Does the Company have procedures in place for sustainable sourcing (including transportation)?

If yes, what percentage of your inputs was sourced sustainably? Also, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so.

Yes. The Company has established an internal mechanism for continual improvement process towards sustainable excellence and has taken adequate steps for safe transportation and optimization of logistics, which in turn is improving the Company's manufacturing system, creating a safe work-place and offering opportunities to our employees to excel and explore their potential and also mitigating the impact on climate. The use of appropriate mode of transportation is a continuous part of effective supply-chain mechanism and the Company's endeavor to reduce transport related environmental impact is an ongoing process.

Major associates of the Company, who are engaged in supplying of maximum level of raw materials for shoe manufacturing process in all manufacturing Units across India, are located nearby to the respective Units. This helps the Company to minimize its transportation cost and environmental impact.

4. Has the Company taken any steps to procure goods and services from local & small producers, including communities surrounding their place of work?

If yes, what steps have been taken to improve their capacity and capability of local and small vendors?

Yes. The Company has taken necessary steps to procure goods and services from the local and small producers

surrounding its manufacturing plants and enhancing their capabilities for a sustainable growth. The Company always prefers to procure goods and services, e.g., Finished Goods Supplies, Security / Housekeeping / loading-unloading operations, etc. from nearby suitable source of supply. The Company has worked out Individual Factory Development Plan (IFDP) of all the manufacturing facilities which is being continuously monitored to improve capacity, capability & quality of the products of all local & small producers.

Other initiatives like Local to Local (L2L) sourcing and regional sourcing also offers various opportunities for the vendors in nearby localities. Apart from this, the Company has also been imparting various technical trainings to local producers to enhance their skill & capability.

5. Does the Company have a mechanism to recycle products and waste? If yes what is the percentage of recycling of products and waste (separately as <5%, 5-10%, >10%). Also, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so.

Yes. Under 3R initiative, the Company has introduced mechanisms to recycle its products/materials to significantly reduce waste. Such initiatives which efficiently manage waste reduction & cuts down waste generation to an insignificant quantity are following (>10%) :

- 100% recycling of EVA Hawaii, rubber Hawaii, PVC and laminated textile wastes
- Tyre upcycling for sole making
- Eliminating carry bags by innovative packing re-design of shoe boxes
- From HDPE bags to re-usable EVA packing (Bags consumed during EVA mixing process)
- STP Plants for waste-water treatment to achieve Zero Liquid Discharge and 100% reuse of water in cleaning, gardening and other routine works.
- Oil filtration & reuse: Sold (only) to the agencies approved by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) for recycling and re-use in other allied industries.
- Scrap Materials Reuse: Leather cuttings, waste papers, metallic grinders and other kind of wastes being sold to outside agencies which are PCB approved.

PRINCIPLE 3: BUSINESS SHOULD PROMOTE THE WELL BEING OF ALL EMPLOYEES

1. Please indicate the Total number of employees.

Sl. No.	Category of Manpower	No. of employees (As on March 31, 2022)
1.	Managerial staff	987
2.	Non-managerial staff in manufacturing	1827
3.	Managers + Permanent employees in stores	1543
4.	Contracted and Third Party employees	4273
Total		8630

2. Please indicate the Total number of employees hired on temporary / contractual / casual basis.

Out of the above, 4273 persons were hired on temporary / contractual / casual basis.

3. Please indicate the Number of permanent women employees.

There are 459 permanent women employees.

4. Please indicate the Number of permanent employees with disabilities.

There are 18 permanent employees with disabilities.

5. Do you have an employee association that is recognized by management?

Yes, there are recognized trade unions in the manufacturing units and retail store of the Company as recognized by its management. These trade unions are affiliated to various central trade union bodies.

6. What percentage of your permanent employees are members of this recognized employee association?

Around 45% of the Company's permanent employees are members of recognized employee associations.

7. Please indicate the Number of complaints relating to child labour, forced labour, involuntary labour, sexual harassment in the last financial year and pending, as on the end of the financial year.

During the financial year ended March 31, 2022, under the Policy on Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, 6 cases were reported out of which 5 cases were disposed of (including withdrawn).

The Company did not receive any complaints relating to child labour, forced labour, involuntary labour.

8. What percentage of your under mentioned employees were given safety & skill up-gradation training in the last year?

- (a) Permanent Employees: 74.2%
- (b) Permanent Women Employees: 80%
- (c) Casual / Temporary / Contractual Employees: 84.9%
- (d) Employees with Disabilities: 11.1%

PRINCIPLE 4: BUSINESS SHOULD RESPECT THE INTERESTS OF AND BE RESPONSIVE TOWARDS ALL STAKEHOLDERS, ESPECIALLY THOSE WHO ARE DISADVANTAGED, VULNERABLE AND MARGINALIZED

1. Has the Company mapped its internal and external stakeholders?

The Company understands the requirements of its various stakeholders. However, the Company is in the process of formal mapping of its key internal and external stakeholders for a better understanding of their concerns and expectations.

2. Out of the above, has the Company identified the disadvantaged, vulnerable & marginalized stakeholders.

Once the mapping is finalized, the Company will be able to identify its various categories of stakeholders and include them in the business process accordingly.

3. Are there any special initiatives taken by the Company to engage with the disadvantaged, vulnerable and marginalized stakeholders. If so, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so.

The CSR programmes of the Company has been designed in such a manner that it ensures benefits to the poor, needy, underprivileged, deserving and the socio-economic backward communities of the society at large. The Company has been actively associated with the Bata Children's Programme (BCP) initiatives of Bata Shoe Organization (BSO) globally, towards improving the lives of the underprivileged children, especially the girl child.

PRINCIPLE 5: BUSINESS SHOULD RESPECT AND PROMOTE HUMAN RIGHTS

1. Does the policy of the Company on human rights cover only the Company or extend to the Group / Joint Ventures / Suppliers / Contractors / NGOs / Others?

Yes. The Company's Code of Ethics covers the aspects of Human Rights and is made applicable to all stakeholders including its Suppliers and Contractors by making them to sign the Code of Ethics and Code of Conduct.

2. How many stakeholder complaints have been received in the past financial year and what percent was satisfactorily resolved by the management?

During the year under review, no complaints relating to human rights violation were received by the Company.

PRINCIPLE 6: BUSINESS SHOULD RESPECT, PROTECT AND MAKE EFFORTS TO RESTORE THE ENVIRONMENT

1. Does the policy related to Principle 6 cover only the Company or extends to the Group / Joint Ventures/ Suppliers / Contractors / NGOs / others.

The Company's Environment, Health & Safety (EHS) Policy extends to cover the Company and all its relevant Stakeholders, viz., manufacturing facilities, suppliers & contractors under its operational area.

Achieved ISO 14001:2015 certification (Environment Management Systems) at our Batanagar plant, Kolkata.

2. Does the Company have strategies / initiatives to address global environmental issues such as climate change, global warming, etc.? Y / N. If yes, please give hyperlink for webpage etc.

The Company has taken multiple necessary steps as mentioned in points # 1,2 & 5 (Sub-part of Principle 2) towards reduction of GHGs emission in its manufacturing process and to reduce the concerns relating to environment & global warming.

3. Does the Company identify and assess potential environmental risks? Y/N

The Company has identified potential environmental risks in its manufacturing Units across India through monitoring system. Required necessary steps and safeguarding measures have been taken by the Company to reduce its impact on the environment.

4. Does the Company have any project related to Clean Development Mechanism? If so, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so. Also, if Yes, whether any environmental compliance report is filed?

No.

5. **Has the Company undertaken any other initiatives on - clean technology, energy efficiency, renewable energy, etc. Y/N. If yes, please give hyperlink for web page etc.**

Your Company has diligently addressed & responsibly implemented multiple initiatives in regard to Clean Technology, Energy efficiency etc. as mentioned above under Principle 2.

These details are also given in the BR Report of the Company that may be viewed on the website of the Company www.bata.in at the link <https://www.bata.in/annual-reports.html>.

6. **Are the Emissions / Waste generated by the Company within the permissible limits given by CPCB/SPCB for the financial year being reported?**

Yes, emission / waste generated by the Company are within the permissible limits prescribed by CPCB / SPCB.

7. **Number of show cause / legal notices received from CPCB / SPCB which are pending (i.e. not resolved to satisfaction) as on end of Financial Year.**

The Company did not receive any show cause / legal notice from CPCB / SPCB during the financial year ended March 31, 2022 and no show cause / legal notice related to CPCB / SPCB are pending with the Company as on the end of the financial year.

PRINCIPLE 7: BUSINESS WHEN ENGAGED IN INFLUENCING PUBLIC AND REGULATORY POLICY, SHOULD DO SO IN A RESPONSIBLE MANNER

1. **Is your Company a member of any trade and chamber or association? If Yes, Name only those major ones that your business deals with:**

The Company believes that conducting business as a good corporate citizen of the Country enhances brand value and leads to a sustainable growth. The Company is associated with Retailers Association of India (RAI).

2. **Have you advocated / lobbied through above associations for the advancement or improvement of public good? Yes / No; if yes specify the broad areas (Governance and Administration, Economic Reforms, Inclusive Development Policies, Energy security, Water, Food Security, Sustainable Business Principles, Others)**

Yes, the Company has worked in the following areas:

- Structural changes in policies to boost growth of the footwear industry. (Economic Reforms)
- Elimination of unfair Labour practices including Child labour in the footwear industry. (Others)

PRINCIPLE 8: BUSINESS SHOULD SUPPORT INCLUSIVE GROWTH AND EQUITABLE DEVELOPMENT

1. **Does the Company have specified programmes / initiatives / projects in pursuit of the policy related to Principle 8? If yes details thereof.**

The Company from its very inception has been involved with charities and a host of philanthropic and social activities. Recognizing communities and employees as the key success factors for business prosperity, the Company remains committed to their development. The CSR initiatives of the Company ensures its commitment to operate in an economically, socially and environmentally sustainable manner, in the best interest of all the stakeholders.

The Board's Report, which forms part of this Annual Report, contains details of our social inclusion initiatives. The Company has a CSR Policy in place to ensure the inclusive growth and equitable development of people in different strata's of economic pyramid.

2. **Are the programmes / projects undertaken through in-house team / own foundation / external NGO / government structures / any other organization?**

The Company's CSR activities are undertaken by an internal dedicated team and also through external NGOs. The names of such NGOs have been disclosed in the **Annexure - IV** to the Board's Report.

Employee volunteers also come forward and participate in the CSR activities. The Company partners with Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs), Government Institutions and well known body corporates for design and implementation of selected projects.

3. **Have you done any impact assessment of your initiative?**

Although not mandatory, the Company conducts periodic assessments for its projects under the CSR programmes. The impact assessments are discussed at CSR Committee and Board Meetings and updates on the utilization, certifications and details received from the implementing agencies are placed at the CSR Committee Meetings for its review and assessment.

4. What is your Company's direct contribution to community development projects and the details of the projects undertaken:

During the financial year ended March 31, 2022, the Company has spent a total amount of **Rs. 58.73 Million*** towards various CSR projects as against the allocated budget of **Rs. 57 Million**. The details thereof have been provided in the "Annual Report on CSR Activities" as attached to the Board's Report. A brief summary thereof is as under:

Sl. No.	Focus Area	Amount (Rs. in Million)
1.	Promotion of education in schools	24.89
2.	COVID-19 & Supporting cause of disability	9.20
3.	Stride with Pride campaign – Footwear donation campaign	18.13
4.	Environment Sustainability	0.25
5.	Treatment of children with Club Foot disease	0.08
6.	Cost of CSR professional, audit, etc.	1.16
Total		53.71

**Includes amount available for set-off from preceding financial year and excess CSR spend of Rs. 1.73 million to be carried forward.*

5. Have you taken steps to ensure that this community development initiative is successfully adopted by the community? Please explain in 50 words, or so.

The Board's Report, which forms part of this Annual Report, contains details of our community development initiatives.

PRINCIPLE 9: BUSINESS SHOULD ENGAGE WITH AND PROVIDE VALUE TO THEIR CUSTOMERS AND CONSUMERS IN A RESPONSIBLE MANNER

1. What percentage of customer complaints / consumer cases are pending as on the end of financial year.

During the year under review, the Company has ensured to address and resolve customer complaints / consumer cases amicably and has further strengthened its Customer Care Team and improvised the complaints redressal processes for speedy resolution of customer complaints. The Company has received 1,99,770 customer / consumer complaints during the year under review and have resolved 1,98,309 complaints amicably during the financial year 2021-22. Remaining 1461 (~0.7%) complaints lying pending at the end of financial year has since been resolved.

Multiple new initiatives were rolled out – we implemented multiple automations with our new CRM Ticketing tool and thus semi-automated Customer Service operations, implementation of refund automation solutions and implemented slew of measures to reduce contacts at the contact center. During the year under review, the focus was primarily to pivot the Customer Service function keeping in mind the new consumer buying behaviour & the subsequent post sales expectations. This involved defining the end-to-end consumer journeys and identifying the key pillars of change.

2. Does the Company display product information on the product label, over and above what is mandated as per local laws? Yes / No / N.A. / Remarks (additional information)

All mandatory declarations as require under the Legal Metrology Act and the Rules made thereunder are duly displayed on the Principal display Panel (PDP) of the products.

3. Is there any case filed by any stakeholder against the Company regarding unfair trade practices, irresponsible advertising and / or anti-competitive behaviour during the last five years and pending as on end of financial year. If so, provide details thereof, in about 50 words or so.

One of the customers filed a complaint before district forum in Chandigarh alleging unfair trade practice for charging of carry bag with Bata Logo. The matter was decided in customers favour granting monetary compensation which was upheld by State Forum. We challenged both the orders before National Forum and after hearing the matter on merits, the National forum was pleased to stay the orders of district and State forum and also permitted us to charge for the carry bags. The matter is pending sub-judice.

4. Did your Company carry out any consumer survey / consumer satisfaction trends?

Yes, the Company inducted a strong Customer Feedback program to capture feedback from customers on their shopping experience across all supported channels and measures it as per the global standard tool NPS (Net Promoter Score) periodically. The Company has started an initiative to close loop Detractors (customers who give negative feedback) by calling them and addressing / resolving their queries. There are certain other feedbacks as well which the Company has started taking from customers with regards to product quality, product launches, shopping preferences, company's distribution business, etc. as part of the larger NPS program. We also measure transaction feedback in terms of Customer Satisfaction when a customer creates a touchpoint with Customer Service.